

Up & Down — Operator Guide

For 50pick staff who run the Up & Down game. No technical knowledge needed.

1 · What the game is

A player bets whether a price — gold, silver, an index — will go **UP** or **DOWN** over a short window: 5, 15 or 30 minutes. We call one window a **round**.

1. Round opens

We read the price from an approved website and write it down.

2. Players bet

They pick UP or DOWN before the round closes.

3. Round closes

We read the price again, from the same website.

4. We pay

UP wins, DOWN wins, or nobody wins and everyone is refunded.

The price must move by more than a small amount — the **margin**, normally 0.50% — for a side to win. If it moves less than that, the round is **VOID** and **every player gets their full stake back**. Nobody loses money on a round that barely moved.

KEY IDEA A round is settled against the exact web page it was opened on. When a round opens we save the link, and when it closes we go back to that same link. If anything about the price cannot be confirmed, the round is voided and refunded — **we never guess a price**.

2 · The three screens you use

All under **Up & Down** in the admin sidebar. Up & Down is a separate game from normal polls, so it has its own section — you will not find its rounds under Markets.

SCREEN	WHAT YOU DO THERE
Overview	Add the things you trade (an asset , e.g. Gold), turn them on/off, and start or pause the timers (chains) that produce rounds. Also where you set the margin and choose where prices are read from.
AI proposals	Ask the AI to suggest a new market. It reads the approved website itself and reports what it found. You check it, change anything you want, then approve and start it.
Rounds	Every round that has ever run: when it opened and closed, who won, how much was staked. This is also where you can cancel a stuck round and refund everyone.

3 · Your daily check — five minutes

1. **Open “Rounds.”** Are recent rounds settling? A healthy day shows UP and DOWN outcomes, not a long run of VOID.

2. **Look at the VOID count.** A few voids are normal. Many voids in a row means either the price is not moving enough (margin too wide) or we cannot read the website.
3. **Open “Overview.”** Under price readings, each asset should show a recent price and a recent time. A dash (–) means we have not been able to read it.
4. **Check the chains are running** — not paused, unless you paused them on purpose.
5. **Check the Void rate column** on each chain. Amber at 40% or more means that market needs attention.

REMEMBER A void is not a loss. Every player gets their full stake back and we take no fee. A high void rate is a *quality* problem, not a money problem — but it makes the game boring, so fix it.

4 · Starting a new market

Option A — Let the AI propose it (easiest)

1. Go to **Up & Down** → **AI proposals**.
2. Pick the asset and the round length. Press **Ask the AI to propose**.
3. The AI opens the approved website and tells you **the price and the time it actually found there**. This appears in the “What it found there” column.
4. If it shows a dash, **that page cannot be used** — the AI could not read a price. This is normal and it is the check doing its job. Try another page or another asset.
5. If it shows a price, press **Review**. Change the link, round length, margin or wording if you want. Then **Approve**.
6. Press **Arm** and type **ARM** to confirm. The market starts at the next boundary.

Option B — Set it up yourself

1. **Overview** → **Add asset**: name, symbol, and the web page the price comes from. That page's website must already be approved under **Sources & categories**.
2. Turn the asset **on**.
3. **Add chain**: choose the asset and 5, 15 or 30 minutes.
4. Press **Start**.

5 · When something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Price shows —, rounds keep voiding	We cannot read the price from that website.	Pause the chain. Tell the technical team. Players are safe — they are being refunded.
“Awaiting confirmation” for a long time	We are retrying the price reading. This is by design.	Wait. If it never confirms the round voids and refunds by itself.
A round is stuck and holds player money	Something has gone wrong for that round.	Rounds → Void. Give a clear reason. Every stake is refunded in full.
Too many VOID results	The margin is too wide for how much that price moves.	Lower the margin for that chain (e.g. 0.50% → 0.30%). It only affects new rounds.
You cannot change an asset's web page	Rounds are still open on the old page.	This is correct — those players were told the old page. Pause, let them finish, then change it.
Top bar shows “AI off”	Usually means the AI key is missing, not that someone switched it off.	Tell the technical team. You can still review and start proposals already in the list.

6 · Five rules — never break these

- 1. Never change where a price comes from while a round is open.** Those players were told one source; the round must finish on it. The system will stop you — do not look for a way around it.

2. Never approve a proposal with no price shown. A dash means the AI could not read that page. Starting it anyway means rounds that cannot settle.

3. Never use the “Simulated” price feed on real money. It invents prices. It is for testing only, and it will ask you to type `SIMULATED` to confirm — that prompt is your warning to stop.

4. Never announce a price we have not confirmed. If a screen shows a dash, that is the honest answer. Do not fill it in from another website.

5. Always give a real reason when you void a round. It is a permanent record and the company may have to explain it.

7 · Words you will see

WORD	MEANING
Asset	A thing with a price — Gold, Silver, S&P 500.
Chain	One asset at one round length. Gold-15min is one chain. A chain produces rounds automatically.
Round	One 5, 15 or 30-minute window that players bet on.
Margin	How far the price must move for a side to win. Normally 0.50%.
VOID	No winner. Every stake refunded in full, no fee taken.
Boundary	The clock moment a round opens and the next one starts — :00, :15, :30, :45.
Proposal	An AI suggestion for a new market. It does nothing until a person approves and arms it.
Arm	Turning an approved proposal into a live, running market.

IF IN DOUBT **Pause the chain.** Pausing stops new rounds and lets open ones finish normally — no player is left holding a bet. It is always safe, it never needs technical help, and it can be undone in one click.

50pick · Up & Down Operator Guide · Internal use only. Technical detail lives in `docs/UPDOWN-SPEC.md` and `docs/UPDOWN-ARCHITECTURE.md` — you do not need them to run the game.